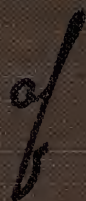
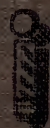


Practice and Science



STANDARD BARBERING



by

S. C. THORPE

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Practice and Science
of
STANDARD BARBERING

A practical and complete course of training in
basic barber services and
related barber science.

Prepared Especially For Use By

- BARBER SCHOOLS
- BARBER APPRENTICES
- BARBER STUDENTS
- PRACTICING BARBERS

**IN PREPARATION FOR
BARBER STATE BOARD EXAMINATIONS**

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FOREWORD

“The Practice and Science of Standard Barbering” marks a major advance in barber training. With the help of leading barber schools, instructors and educators, all the essential fundamentals and know-how of barbering have been combined into one comprehensive textbook.

Step-by-step instructions are clearly described for basic barber services. Many illustrations, charts, examinations and a glossary have been included. The regular study of this text assures complete training and thorough preparation for State Board Examinations.

Every barber who wants to combine professional skill with modern, scientific knowledge, and desires to maintain high standards of service will find that this text answers a real need.

THE AUTHOR.

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HISTORY OF BARBERING

HISTORY OF BARBERING

The history of barbering is deeply rooted in the progress of mankind. As civilization advanced, barbering developed from an insignificant practice to a recognized vocation. To study the history of barbering is to appreciate the accomplishments and the role of the barber in early times. This rich cultural heritage should be the basis for prestige and respect in serving the public.

Primitive man had to devise rather crude instruments with which to cut the hair. Simple cutting implements were usually prepared from sharpened flint or oyster shells. To this very day, the savages of Polynesia still use similar objects in cutting the hair.

Superstitions

The beginning of barbering was steeped in strange superstitions. There was a general belief among savages that people could be bewitched by hair clippings. Hence, the privilege of hair cutting was designated to the priest or medicine man of the tribe. The Irish peasantry believed that if hair cuttings were burned or buried no evil spirits would haunt the individual.

Among the American Indians, the belief existed that the hair had a vital connection with the body, and that "anyone possessed of a lock of hair of another might work his will on that individual."

It was the widespread ancient belief in the magic influence of long-haired persons which caused Roman judges to order the hair of Christian martyrs cut before putting them to death.

Origin of the Barber

As far back as four hundred years before Christ, shaving was introduced by the Macedonians. Later it spread to Egypt and all Eastern countries, including China. The word barber is derived from a Latin word "barba" meaning

beard. The word tonsorial in Latin means the cutting, clipping and trimming of hair with shears or cutting with a razor.

Beautifying the Body

The Egyptians were the first to cultivate beauty in an extravagant fashion. Excavations from tombs have brought to light such relics as combs, brushes, mirrors and cosmetics. Eye paint was the most popular of all cosmetics. Slaves enhanced the beauty of the Egyptian ladies by applying perfumed oil to their skins and henna to their hair.

Significance of the Beard

Although the importance of the beard belongs more with the past than to the present, nevertheless, it is interesting to note the various fashions and customs associated with it. A curious custom of the Middle Ages was that of imbedding three hairs from the king's beard in the wax of the seal. During the reign of Queen Elizabeth in England, it was fashionable to dye the beard and cut it into a variety of shapes.

In early times, the beard was considered by almost all nations as a sign of wisdom, strength and manhood, and was carefully cherished as being almost sacred. Among the Jews, the beard was regarded as a symbol of manliness; to cut off another man's beard was an outrage. According to the Greek philosopher, Pythagoras, the hair was the source of the brain's inspiration and the cutting of the hair decreased intellectual capacity. In Rome, the first day of shaving (22nd birthday) was looked upon as a sign of manhood and was celebrated with great festivities.

The commands of certain rulers were at times responsible for the removal of beards. For instance, Alexander the Great ordered his soldiers to shave so that their enemies might not seize their beards in battle. After the Gauls were conquered, Julius Caesar compelled them to cut off their beards. Peter the Great made shaving compulsory by imposing a tax on beards.

In the spread of the Christian faith, long hair gradually became to be despised because it was considered sinful. Hence the clergy were directed to shave their beards. Among the Jews, shaving of the beard was forbidden, but they used the scissors to remove all excess hair. The Moslems observed great care in trimming the beard after prayer, and the hairs that fell out were carefully picked up and preserved for subsequent burial with the owner.

Barbers first became popular in Rome about the year 296 B.C. In Greece, barbers became popular as early as 500 B.C.

Greek and Roman Influence

In Greece and Rome, barbering was a highly developed art. Persons of means were shaved by their valets. The common people frequented the barber shops which were the resorts of loungers and newsmongers.

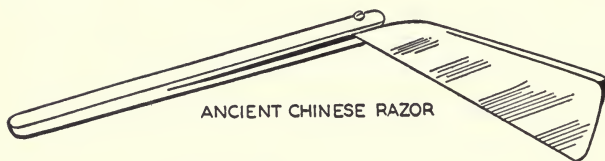
The Greeks and Romans gave considerable attention to beautifying the hair. Sparkling gems and hairpins of silver and gold adorned the elegant hair styles of the Greek women. The Roman women often dyed their hair, and some replaced the hair with fashionable wigs.

In ancient Rome, the color of a woman's hair indicated her rank. Women of the nobility tinted their hair red; those of the middle class colored their hair yellow; while women of the poorer classes were compelled to dye their hair black.

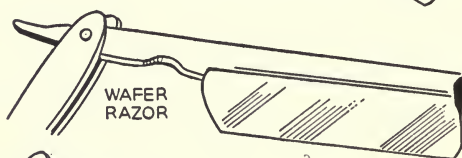
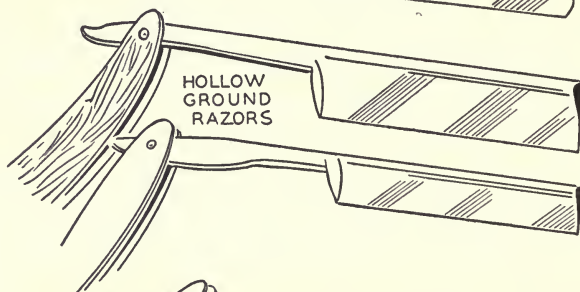
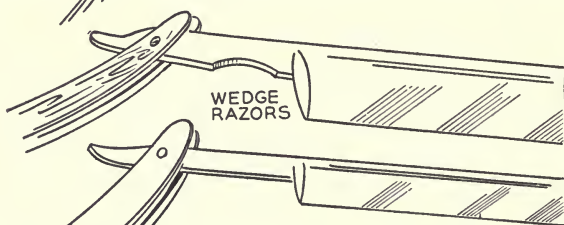
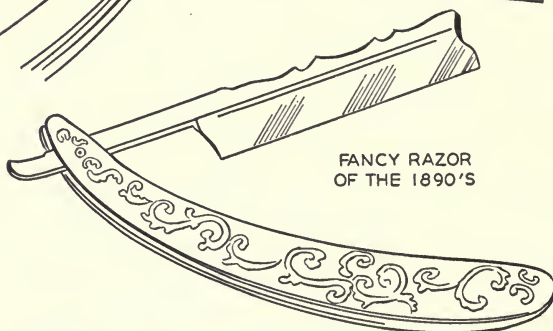
The Greeks were noted for the cultivation of health by natural methods. They realized the value of exercise and massage for building a strong body. Hippocrates, the father of modern medicine, advocated the use of sunlight, water and diet, as important aids to recovery from illness. The motto of the Greeks was "a sound mind in a sound body".

Some of the finest bathing establishments were erected in Rome. Soap was first discovered and came into common usage there. Later, with the decay of Rome and the rise of Christianity, the use of soap and bathing was banned because these practices were associated with the cruelty and wickedness of Roman rulers.

RAZORS OF THE PAST



ANCIENT CHINESE RAZOR

WAFER
RAZORHOLLOW
GROUND
RAZORSWEDGE
RAZORSFANCY RAZOR
OF THE 1890'S

English Influence

The ancient Britons were extremely proud of the length and beauty of their hair. Their yellow hair was brightened with washes composed of tallow, lime, and the ashes of certain vegetables. The Danes and Anglo-Saxons also admired long, flowing locks. The young Danes were particularly attentive to dressing the hair, which they combed at least once a day in order to captivate the affections of English ladies.

The Rise and Fall of Barber-Surgeons

During the Middle Ages, the barbers not only practiced shaving, haircutting and hairdressing, but also dressed wounds and performed surgical operations. That is why they were called barber-surgeons. Much of the barbers' experience was acquired from the monks, whom they assisted in the practice of surgery and medicine.

The barber-surgeons became quite numerous when Pope Alexander III forbade the clergy to shed blood in surgical operations. To protect themselves, the Barbers' Company of London was organized in the thirteenth century. The object of the trade guild was to regulate the profession for the benefit of its members. Among the regulations passed was that no barber was to keep more than four apprentices in his establishment.

The Company of Barbers was ruled by a Master, and consisted of two classes of barbers, viz: those who practiced barbering and those who specialized in surgery. Under Edward III, the barbers made a complaint against unskilled practitioners in surgery. As a result, the court chose two Masters to inspect and rule the guild and give examinations to test the skill of applicants.

The sign of the barber-surgeon consisted of a striped pole from which was suspended a basin: the fillet around the pole indicating the bandage twisted around the arms previous to blood-letting and the basin the vessel for receiving blood. Another interpretation of the colors in the barber's pole was that

red represented the blood, blue the veins, and white the bandage. This sign, without the basin, has been generally retained by the modern barber.

Besides the Barbers' Guild, there was also a Surgeons' Guild in England. There was reason to believe that competition and antagonism existed between these two organizations. In 1450, both groups were united by law for the purpose of fostering the science of surgery. A law was enacted that no one doing surgery should practice barbering and that no barber should practice any point in surgery except the pulling of teeth. The long slumbering jealousy between the two guilds soon reached a climax. The surgeons harbored a dislike for a system under which the diplomas were signed by Governors, two of whom were always barbers. Finally, in 1745 a bill was passed separating the barbers from the surgeons.

The barber-surgeons also flourished in France and Germany. In 1371, a corporation was organized for the French barber-surgeons under the rule of the King's barber. With the advent of the French revolution, the corporation was dissolved. Wigs became so elaborate in the nineteenth century that a separate corporation of barbers was formed in France. Not until 1779 was a corporation formed in Prussia. This was disbanded in 1809 when new unions were started.

The Dutch and Swedish settlers in America brought with them barber-surgeons from their native countries to look after the well being of the colonists. They not only shaved but performed everyday medical and surgical procedures.

Modern Trends

By the nineteenth and twentieth centuries, barbering was completely separated from religion and medicine, and began to take on an independent position. Rapid strides have been made in barbering since the invention of electricity, the development of better instruments for cutting and shaving the hair, and the discoveries in hygiene, chemistry and medicine.

With the exception of Virginia and certain counties in

Alabama, the remaining states have passed laws regulating the practice of barbering. The state boards are primarily interested in maintaining high standards of education and training in order to assure competent and intelligent service. The barber schools, barber unions, and Master Barbers Association, have cooperated in the enforcement of state laws and in the protection of the barbers' rights and privileges.

Important discoveries which have improved the practice of barbering in recent times are as follows:

1. The use of electricity and electrical appliances in the barber shop.
2. The use of better barber implements.
3. The practice of sterilization and sanitation in the barber shop.
4. The study of anatomy dealing with those parts of the body (face, head and neck) which are served by the barber.
5. The study of preparations used in connection with facial, scalp and hair treatments.

Historical Notes on Barbering

The Journeymen Barbers' Union was organized 1887, and the first convention was held on November 5, 1887, at Buffalo, New York.

The first barber school in the United States was started by A. B. Moler in Chicago, in 1893.

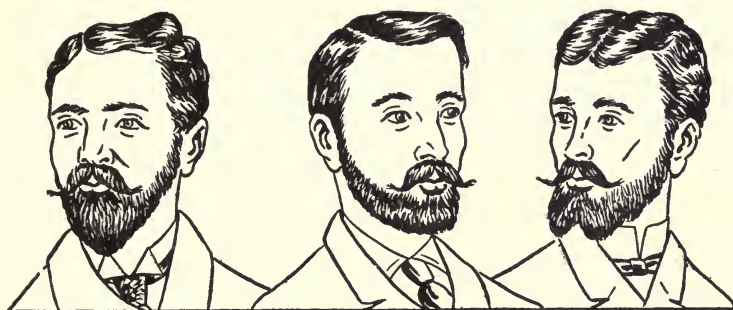
The first state to pass a barber license law was Minnesota, in 1897.

The Associated Master Barbers of America was organized in 1924, at Chicago, Illinois.

HAIRCUTS AND BEARDS IN VOGUE AT THE ONSET OF THE 20th CENTURY



HAIRCUTS AND BEARDS IN VOGUE DURING THE 19th CENTURY



HISTORY OF BARBERING

1. What is the origin of the word "barber"?	"Barba" is a Latin word meaning beard.
2. Why did men wear beards in ancient times?	They were signs of wisdom, strength and manhood.
3. Name two ancient nations which practiced barbering.	Ancient Egypt and China.
4. When did the Macedonians introduce the practice of shaving?	About 400 years B.C. (before the birth of Christ).
5. In what year did barbers become known in Rome?	About 296 B.C.
6. When did barbers become popular in Greece?	About 500 B.C.
7. Who were the barber-surgeons?	Barbers who assisted the clergy in the practice of surgery and medicine.
8. a) When did the barber-surgeons start their practice? b) When did the barber-surgeons end their practice?	About 110 A.D. (after the birth of Christ). In the year 1745.
9. What were the duties of the barber-surgeons?	Besides being a barber, they did blood-letting, performed operations, pulled teeth and dressed wounds.
10. Describe the barber's sign used by the barber-surgeons.	The barber's sign consisted of a striped pole, from which was suspended a basin. The white band around the pole indicated the ribbon for bandaging the arm, the red band indicated the bleeding and the basin was intended to receive the blood.
11. What was the origin of the modern barber pole?	The modern barber pole started in the days when the barber-surgeons bled their patients in treating disease.
12. What kind of organization was the Barbers' Company of London?	A trade guild or society for the protection of barber-surgeons.
13. When was the Barbers' Company organized in London?	During the thirteenth century.
14. When was the first school for barber-surgeons opened in France?	In the middle of the thirteenth century.
15. Who brought the barber-surgeons to America?	The early Dutch and Swedish settlers.
16. In what year did A. B. Moller open the first barber school in America?	In 1893.
17. In what year did the State of Minnesota pass the first barber license law?	In 1897.

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- | | |
|---|---|
| 18. What are three important advantages of having barber license laws? | <ul style="list-style-type: none">1. Elevates the standards and practice of barbering.2. Eliminates incompetent barbers who lack the required training and experience.3. Protects the public health and assures better service. |
|---|---|
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| 19. In what year were the Master Barbers of America organized? | In 1924. |
|---|----------|
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| 20. When was the Journeymen Barbers' International Union organized in America? | In 1887. |
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|--|--|
| 21. Which important discoveries improved the practice of barbering in recent years? | <ul style="list-style-type: none">1. The use of electricity and electrical appliances in the barber shop.2. The use of better barber implements.3. The practice of sterilization and sanitation in the barber shop.4. The study of anatomy dealing with those parts of the body (face, head and neck) which are serviced by the barber.5. The study of preparations used in connection with facial, scalp and hair treatments. |
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PART I

HYGIENE, SANITATION AND STERILIZATION

